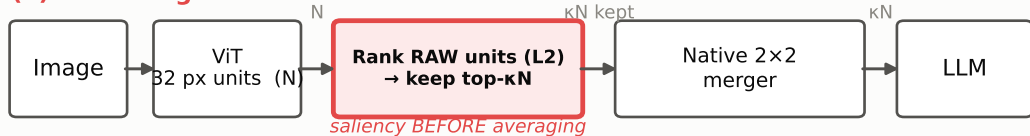
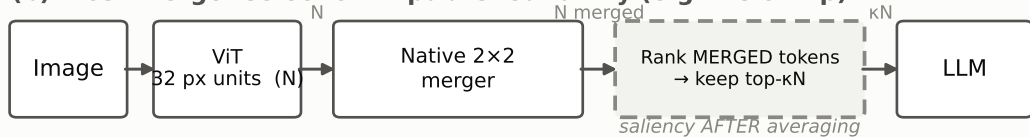


(a) Pre-merger selection — this work



(b) Post-merger selection — published family (e.g. VisionZip)



Native 2×2 merger (+ deepstack mergers on Qwen3-VL) and LLM are identical in (a) and (b); only the saliency tap point differs.